

February

17

1454

Unique feast

At an extravagant banquet known as the Feast of the Pheasant in Lille in modern-day France, guests were treated to spectacular entertainment, such as an enormous pie with musicians playing inside.



Born this day

1917 Whang-od, traditional Filipino tattooist. She is the last and oldest person to perform her craft.

1963 Michael Jordan, Black American basketball player. He led the Chicago Bulls to six National Basketball Association (NBA) championships and is considered one of the greatest basketball players of all time.

Red cross

A group of Swiss citizens in Geneva set up the International Committee for Relief to the Wounded, later renamed the International Committee of the Red Cross, to help people injured in conflicts.

1863

1972

Volkswagen Beetle

When the 15,007,034th VW Beetle rolled off the production line, the Beetle overtook Henry Ford's Model T as the world's bestselling car. Its compact design and affordable price made it a hit with drivers around the globe.



Also on this day

1936 The Phantom, a crime-fighting cartoon character created by US writer Lee Falk, first appeared in comics. Although he had no special powers, his heroic actions, colourful costume, and mask made him the world's first superhero.

1869 The periodic table of elements was first written down by Russian chemist Dmitri Mendeleev.

2008 Kosovo declared independence from Serbia, following years of conflict between the Serbians and the Kosovans, who have Albanian heritage.